

FFXIV Character Search - User Guide

Development Team

February 11, 2025

1 Introduction

FFXIV Character Search is a React-based web application that allows users to search for and view character information from Final Fantasy XIV using the Lodestone website.

2 Prerequisites

Before running the application, ensure you have the following installed:

- Node.js (version 14 or higher)
- npm (usually comes with Node.js)
- Git (for version control)

3 Local Development

3.1 Clone the Repository

First, clone the repository using git:

```
1 git clone <repository-url>  
2 cd ffxiv-character-search
```

3.2 Install Dependencies

Install all required dependencies using npm:

```
1 npm install
```

3.3 Running the Development Server

To start the development server:

```
1 npm run dev
```

This will:

- Start the development server on port 3000
- Open your default browser to <http://localhost:3000>
- Enable hot reloading for development

4 Building for Production

To create a production build:

```
1 npm run build
```

This will create optimized files in the `public/dist` directory.

5 GitHub Pages Deployment

5.1 Repository Setup

1. Create a new repository on GitHub 2. Push your code:

```
1 git init
2 git add .
3 git commit -m "Initial commit"
4 git branch -M main
5 git remote add origin https://github.com/username/ffxiv-character-
  search.git
6 git push -u origin main
```

5.2 Enable GitHub Pages

1. Go to your repository's Settings 2. Navigate to Pages section 3. Select:

- Source: Deploy from a branch
- Branch: main
- Folder: `/public`

4. Click Save

Your site will be available at:

<https://username.github.io/ffxiv-character-search>

6 Using the Application

6.1 Searching for Characters

1. Enter a character name (required)
2. Optionally enter:
 - World name
 - Data Center name
3. Click Search
4. Results will display below the search form

6.2 Viewing Character Details

1. From search results, click "Select Character"
2. The character's details will display, including:
 - Character portrait and basic information
 - Combat jobs (Tanks, Healers, DPS)
 - Crafting and Gathering jobs

7 Project Structure

```
1 ffxiv-character-search/  
2   public/  
3     css/  
4     dist/  
5     index.html  
6   src/  
7     components/  
8       CharacterSearch.jsx  
9       SearchForm.jsx  
10      SearchResults.jsx  
11      CharacterDetails.jsx  
12     utils/  
13       api.js  
14     App.jsx  
15     package.json  
16     webpack.config.js
```

8 Troubleshooting

8.1 Common Issues

- If the development server fails to start:
 - Check if port 3000 is already in use
 - Try `npm install` again

- If character searches fail:
 - Verify your internet connection
 - Check if Lodestone is undergoing maintenance
- If GitHub Pages deployment fails:
 - Ensure the repository is public
 - Check if the branch and folder settings are correct

9 Development Notes

- The application uses React for the UI
- Data is fetched directly from Lodestone
- Styling uses CSS modules for component isolation
- Webpack handles bundling and development server